

1 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 15 minutes

Torn-paper garden

What we are practising

Choose shapes and arrange them to represent an idea.

What you need

Paper sheet / Coloured scrap paper / Washable non-toxic glue stick

Arrange pieces without glue, or draw the garden.

Before you begin

Set out a few large paper pieces and a base sheet.

Supervise glue use and keep paper and glue away from the mouth; scissors are unnecessary.

Try it together

1. Tear a long strip for a stem and a broad piece for a flower.
2. Arrange pieces before attaching them.
3. Invite the child to add a path or imaginary plant and describe it.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What could grow in your invented garden?

Space to explore

2 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Become a living statue

What we are practising

Express an idea through movement and describe a creative choice.

What you need

No materials

Use hands, facial expressions or a toy instead of whole-body poses.

Before you begin

Clear a small space and choose seated or standing poses.

Keep feet stable and movements gentle; avoid climbing or balancing on furniture.

Try it together

1. Make a tree pose with arms as branches.
2. Invite your child to make a different tree.
3. Choose another idea, such as a sleepy cat, and take turns guessing the pose.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What could your hands show about your tree?

Space to explore

3 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 15 minutes

Texture rubbing pictures

What we are practising

Explore how a surface pattern can become part of a picture.

What you need

Paper / Large unwrapped crayon / Corrugated cardboard

Draw repeated lines if suitable textured surfaces are unavailable.

Before you begin

Place paper over clean cardboard with the ridges facing up.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Hold the paper steady while rubbing the crayon's side across it.
2. Turn the paper and try rubbing in another direction.
3. Use the pattern as part of a drawing, such as a striped animal or roof.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What could these lines become in your picture?

Space to explore

4 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 15 minutes

A paper character with a voice

What we are practising

Combine visual choices with imaginative storytelling.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Use a sock held loosely over an adult's hand.

Before you begin

Fold a sheet once so it can stand like a tent.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Draw a large face or animal on one side.
2. Give it a name and a voice: "Hello, I am Cloud Cat."
3. Let the character ask for something, then answer through a second pretend character.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What does your character like doing?

Space to explore

5 / 5 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Kitchen sound composer

What we are practising

Choose and organise contrasting sounds.

What you need

Unbreakable bowl / Wooden spoon / Folded towel

Use finger taps on knees and claps only.

Before you begin

Set the bowl and towel on a stable surface.

Use gentle taps only, keep tools away from faces and stop if sounds are uncomfortable.

Try it together

1. Tap the bowl softly once, then tap the towel.
2. Describe how the sounds differ.
3. Invent a three-sound phrase, repeat it, then let your child change one sound.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which sound would suit a sleepy elephant?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Torn-paper garden

A little hint

Turn a paper piece around to discover a new shape.

Answer / what to notice

Any arrangement representing the child's garden works; plants may be imaginary.

Tearing and rearranging allow shapes to change during making.

Make it easier

An adult tears large pieces; the child chooses positions.

Take it further

Add two kinds of plants with different shapes.

Another day, away from the screen

Tell a short story about who visits the garden.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. Become a living statue

A little hint

Think about tall, drooping, wide or windy branches.

Answer / what to notice

Different poses may represent the same idea; explain the chosen feature.

An idea can be communicated with gesture as well as words.

Make it easier

Copy one adult pose.

Take it further

Change a calm tree into a windy tree using only one movement.

Another day, away from the screen

Use a pose to describe a character in a story.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Texture rubbing pictures

A little hint

Press gently and use the crayon's long side.

Answer / what to notice

Visible lines or patches are useful results; the child decides what they represent.

Raised parts underneath receive more rubbing pressure and create a pattern.

Make it easier

Hold the paper for the child.

Take it further

Combine two rubbing directions in one picture.

Another day, away from the screen

Look for another large, clean textured surface to try.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. A paper character with a voice

A little hint

Offer a familiar wish, such as finding a friend or taking a nap.

Answer / what to notice

The child chooses the character and conversation; no realistic drawing is required.

A name, a wish and a voice can turn a simple picture into a story character.

Make it easier

An adult draws while the child chooses features.

Take it further

Give two characters different wishes and invent how they agree.

Another day, away from the screen

Use the character to retell a favourite event.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Kitchen sound composer

A little hint

Try gentle, slow sounds before quicker ones.

Answer / what to notice

Any gentle sound sequence is acceptable; a repeated phrase can form a tiny composition.

Different surfaces vibrate differently, creating different sounds.

Make it easier

Copy two sounds made by the adult.

Take it further

Make two short phrases and choose an ending.

Another day, away from the screen

Add your sounds to a made-up animal story.